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Case Study



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YTL HACKATHON 2026 · ENTERPRISE TRACK A

Project Udyam Digital

Making small businesses go digital in one sitting

Case study and problem statement · Prepared by Ankit Srivastava · October 2026

About this case. Teams submit a working prototype plus a short business case, so we can assess technical depth and business judgement together. The case uses a fictional operator, **Accel Telecom**, and its B2B arm **Accel Business**. All figures and data are synthetic and built for the exercise; they are not company data.

Context

Accel Telecom leads India's mobile market and is a top-2 player in home broadband. Its enterprise arm, Accel Business, serves large corporates well but has a small share of India's 6 crore+ micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs): kirana stores, clinics, coaching centres, small manufacturers, CA firms and restaurants.

These businesses increasingly need more than a SIM. A typical clinic or retail shop now wants fixed broadband or a leased line, a few business SIMs, a WhatsApp/SMS channel to reach customers, cloud email and storage, basic cybersecurity, and CCTV or POS connectivity. Today they buy each piece from a different vendor, often from a local reseller, with no single bill or support number.

Accel Business already offers most of these products, but sells them one at a time through a field sales force built for large accounts. The journey for a small business owner is slow and paper-heavy:

- Needs are discovered in a visit by a sales executive, who often pitches whatever is on target that month
- A quote takes 3–5 days and comes as a PDF with product codes the owner does not understand
- KYC needs GST certificate, Udyam registration, address proof and signatory ID, collected physically or over email
- Installation and activation take 10–14 days on average, with 3–4 follow-up calls from the customer
- Each product is billed and supported separately after activation

As a result, cost to acquire a small business is high, conversion is low, and a large share of interested prospects drop out before activation. Competitors and digital-first players are starting to offer instant online sign-up for single products.

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The problem

Design and build a **digital-first acquisition and onboarding journey** that lets a small business owner discover the right bundle, buy it and get it activated with minimal human effort — on a phone, in their preferred language.

Key questions

1. Which MSME segments should Accel Business prioritise first, and what bundle (products, price point, contract length) fits each?
2. How should needs discovery work without a salesperson? Think of a conversational advisor (chat or voice, in Hindi and regional languages) that asks a few questions and recommends a bundle with a clear monthly price.
3. How can KYC and documentation be made near-instant (e.g. GSTIN/Udyam lookup, document OCR, DigiLocker, e-sign) while staying compliant with the DPDP Act, 2023 — consent, purpose limitation and data minimisation?
4. What role should the existing field force and local channel partners play, so the digital journey adds to them instead of competing with them?
5. How will you measure success? Define the 3–5 metrics that matter (e.g. lead-to-activation conversion, time to activate, cost of acquisition, 6-month churn) and the targets you would set.

Build challenge

Build a working prototype of the journey covering at least:

Advisor	A GenAI-powered assistant that asks about the business (type, size, locations, current tools) and recommends a bundle from the product catalogue, explaining why in plain language
Quote and checkout	A single, transparent monthly price with add-ons the owner can toggle
Smart KYC	Document upload with extraction and validation, mocked lookups of GSTIN and Udyam data, and a clear consent screen
Tracker	An order status view the owner can check instead of calling support

Stretch goals: a voice or WhatsApp front end; a back-office view for sales or partners showing leads the advisor could not close; a simple propensity score for which leads to call.

What teams submit

1. Working prototype (demo video of 3 minutes max + code repository)
2. Solution architecture diagram with the main components and data flows
3. Business case in 10 slides or fewer: target customer, value, pricing or savings, rollout, risks
4. A 1-page note on data privacy and security choices made in the design

Data provided

Students receive **YTL_TrackA_Udyam_Digital_Data.zip**, with a README explaining every column. All data is synthetic: businesses, people and identifiers are fictional.

File	Size	Use it for
product_catalogue.csv	25 products	Advisor recommendations and quotes: price ranges, setup fees, contract length, eligibility rules (city tier, size, GSTIN needed) and product dependencies
smb_leads.csv	5,000 leads	One quarter of SMB leads: profile, source, funnel stage reached, drop reason, stage dates; for activated leads the bundle bought, value, 6-month churn and NPS
mock_gstin_registry.csv	3,534 records	Backing data for a mock GSTIN lookup API (legal name, address, status incl. cancelled/suspended)
mock_udyam_registry.csv	2,723 records	Backing data for a mock Udyam lookup API
kyc_documents/	47 images, 12 applicants	Specimen GST and Udyam certificates, signatory IDs and utility bills for OCR and validation; some contain planted problems

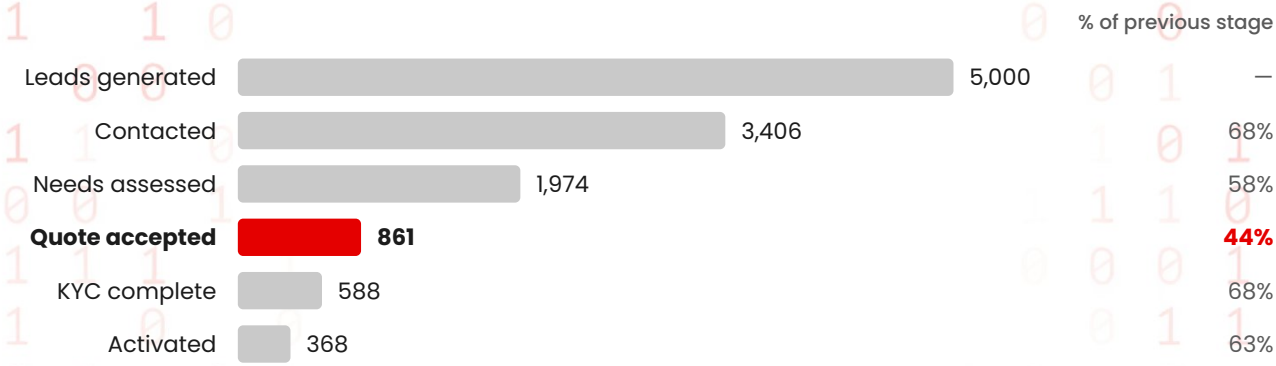
*Judges get a separate pack, **YTL_TrackA_Judges_Only.zip**, which must not be shared with students: 15 advisor test scenarios to run live during demos, the KYC answer key, the signals planted in the leads data, and the scripts that regenerate the data.*

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Appendix A1: SMB acquisition funnel

Only 7% of SMB leads get activated; the steepest drop is from needs assessed to quote accepted

5,000 leads → 368 activations, Apr–Jun 2026 (smb_leads.csv)



Source: smb_leads.csv (synthetic) · Tier 1–2 cities, Apr–Jun 2026

17.6 days	**3×**	**₹15,000**	**9.6% vs 2.0%**
average lead to activation	status chases per customer	blended acquisition cost per activated SMB	activation with vs without GSTIN

Activated customers took 17.6 days on average from lead to activation and chased status 3 times. Blended acquisition cost is about ₹15,000 per activated SMB, against a median bundle of ₹6,900/month (micro businesses average about ₹2,500). Leads with a GSTIN activate at 9.6%, those without at 2.0%.

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Appendix A2: Customer segments (indicative)

Segment	Share of SMB base	Typical example	Current setup	Key needs	Price sensitivity
Micro retail & services	55%	Kirana, salon, pharmacy	Owner's mobile + hotspot, UPI QR	Reliable internet for UPI/POS, WhatsApp catalogue	Very high
Professional offices	25%	Clinic, CA firm, coaching centre	Home broadband, personal Gmail	Uptime, cloud email/storage, data security	Medium
Small multi-site businesses	15%	Restaurant chain, 3–10 store retailer	Mixed ISPs per site, no central IT	One bill, central management, CCTV, failover	Medium–low
Small manufacturers	5%	Auto-parts unit, textile unit	Leased line or local ISP	Dedicated bandwidth, IoT for machines, ERP access	Low